

Sales Cycle Workflow — System Elements Only

Entities

Entity	Purpose
clients	Companies being sold to
contacts	People at those companies
Opportunitys	One row per prospective sale
interactions	Every touchpoint (call, email, meeting, material sent)
pipeline_templates	Industry-specific configuration
stage_checklist_progress	Checklist completion per Opportunity per stage
tasks	Auto-generated from cadence; appear on dashboards
Opportunity_contacts	Multiple contacts per Opportunity with roles

Workflow

1. Opportunity Creation

```
CREATE Opportunity
  → LINK client
  → LINK contact(s)
  → SELECT pipeline_template
  → SET current_stage = 1 (Discover)
  → STAMP stage_entered_date
  → LOAD stage_checklist (from template)
  → LOAD default_cadence (from template)
  → SET disqualify_after_days (from template)
  → SET probability (from template)
```

2. Lead Source Capture

```
SET lead_source
  → structured options (Website, Facebook, LinkedIn, Referral, etc.)
  → OR unstructured free-text (referred by, phone, notes)
```

3. Engage Cadence

FOR each cadence step in template.default_cadence:

- CREATE task
- SET due_date
- SET channel
- SET next_action
- SET next_action_date

4. Interaction Logging

CREATE interaction

- LINK Opportunity
- SET date
- SET channel (call/email/LinkedIn/text/in-person/mail/video/note)
- SET direction (outbound/inbound)
- SET summary
- SET material_shared
- SET outcome (controlled vocabulary)
- UPDATE Opportunity.next_action
- UPDATE Opportunity.next_action_date
- EVALUATE risk_flags

5. Stage Advancement

CHECK stage_checklist_progress

- IF all required items complete:
 - SET current_stage = next
 - STAMP stage_entered_date
 - LOAD new stage_checklist
 - LOAD new cadence (if applicable)
 - UPDATE probability (from template)
- IF manual override:
 - REQUIRE reason

6. Side-State: Nurture

SET current_stage = Nurture

- SET nurture_reason
- SET nurture_revisit_date
- REMOVE from active pipeline
- CREATE task on revisit_date
- RETAIN all history
- ALLOW re-entry at any stage

7. Side-State: Lost

```
SET current_stage = Lost
  → REQUIRE lost_reason (dropdown)
  → SET lost_date
  → REMOVE from active pipeline
  → RETAIN in archive
  → INCLUDE in win/loss reporting
```

8. Close / Handoff

```
SET current_stage = Close
  → SET probability = 100%
  → STAMP closed_date
  → SET closed_won = true
  → TRIGGER handoff workflow
    → CREATE delivery tasks
    → NOTIFY delivery team
    → UPDATE dashboards
```

9. Risk Flag Evaluation

```
FOR each Opportunity:
  → IF no interaction in X days: FLAG stalled
  → IF days_in_stage > template.typical_window: FLAG aging
  → IF last 2+ outbound interactions have no inbound response: FLAG ghosted
  → IF stage_checklist incomplete past X days: FLAG blocked
```

10. Dashboard Computation

PER-OPPORTUNITY DASHBOARD:

```
  → header (client, stage, days_in_stage, Opportunity_value, probability)
  → next_action panel
  → stage_checklist (with checkboxes)
  → interaction_timeline (reverse-chronological)
  → stakeholders (economic_buyer, champion, others)
  → risk_flags
```

MAIN DASHBOARD:

```
  → funnel (count + $ per stage)
  → conversion_rates (stage-to-stage)
  → this_week_actions (next_action_date within 7 days)
  → stalled_at_risk_list (aggregated flags)
  → template_filter (segment by industry)
  → time_in_cycle (avg days Discover→Close vs. target)
```

11. Template Configuration

CREATE pipeline_template

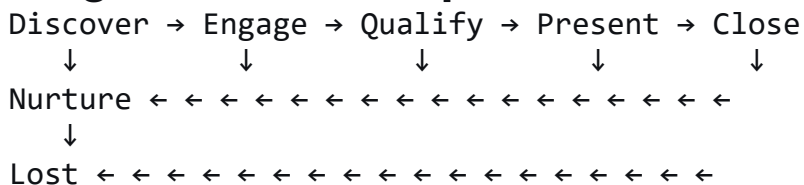
- SET stage_names (1-5, customizable labels)
- SET stage_checklists (per stage)
- SET default_cadence (per stage)
- SET win_criteria_prompt
- SET disqualify_after_days
- SET typical_stage_windows
- SET probability_by_stage

12. Reporting

ON DEMAND:

- win_rate (by template, by rep, by period)
- loss_reasons (aggregated)
- objection_types (aggregated)
- conversion_rates (stage-to-stage)
- time_in_cycle (avg, median, by template)
- material_effectiveness (which assets correlate with stage advancement)

Stage Transition Map



All stages can flow to Nurture or Lost at any point. Nurture can re-enter at any stage. Lost is terminal.

Data Flow Summary

Lead → Client + Contact + Opportunity
Opportunity → Template → Checklist + Cadence + Rules
Cadence → Tasks → Interactions
Interactions → Outcome → Next Action + Risk Flags
Checklist → Stage Gate → Stage Advancement
Stage → Probability + Cadence + Checklist
Close → Handoff → Delivery
Nurture → Revisit Task → Re-entry
Lost → Reason Code → Reporting
All → Dashboards + Reports

Controlled Vocabularies

Field	Values
channel	call, email, LinkedIn, text, in-person, mail, video, note
direction	outbound, inbound, internal
outcome	no response, left voicemail, sent, booked meeting, discovery complete, demo complete, objection: price, objection: timing, objection: authority, objection: need, negotiation: price, negotiation: resolved, closed-won, closed-lost, nurture
lost_reason	price, competitor, timing, no budget, no authority, no need, unresponsive, out of scope
nurture_reason	timing, budget cycle, internal change, rebrand, hiring freeze, other
contact_role	economic_buyer, champion, influencer, blocker, decision_maker, end_user
risk_flag	stalled, aging, ghosted, blocked

Automation Triggers

Trigger	Action
Opportunity created	Load template checklist + cadence + rules
Interaction logged	Update next_action + evaluate risk flags
Checklist complete	Gate stage advancement
Stage advanced	Load new checklist + cadence + update probability
Close won	Trigger handoff workflow
Nurture set	Create revisit task
Lost set	Require reason + update reporting
Revisit date reached	Create re-engagement task
No interaction X days	Flag stalled

Trigger	Action
Days in stage > window	Flag aging
2+ outbound no response	Flag ghosted

Stage Checklist by Template (Example)

Stage	Trades Template	Agency Template
Discover	Confirm decision-maker, trigger event, budget range, service area	Confirm ICP fit, trigger event, budget range, authority
Engage	Two-way conversation, discovery call booked	Two-way conversation, discovery call booked
Qualify	Confirm problem, budget, timeline, economic buyer, champion, win criteria	SPIN questions, budget, timeline, authority, win criteria
Present	Demo, stakeholder map, POC (if required), no unresolved objections	Demo, stakeholder map, POC (if required), no unresolved objections
Close	Proposal sent, negotiation resolved, signature received	Proposal sent, negotiation resolved, signature received

Key Rules

1. No Opportunity deleted — only archived (Lost/Nurture).
2. No stage skipped without manual override + reason.
3. No Lost without a reason code.
4. Every interaction updates next_action.
5. Every stage has a checklist; checklist gates advancement.
6. Every template is configurable; no hardcoded stages.
7. Risk flags are auto-generated, not manually entered.
8. Nurture retains full history; re-entry allowed at any stage.
9. Close triggers handoff; no manual delivery handoff.
10. All dashboards computed from Opportunities + interactions + checklist_progress.

Cadence

Cadence = a pre-defined sequence of outreach touchpoints, spaced over time, that a sales rep follows to engage a prospect.

It's the "rhythm" of follow-up. Instead of a rep randomly deciding when to call or email, the template says: *"Do these touches, in this order, on these days."*

Simple Example

A cadence for the **Engage** stage of a Trades template might be:

Day	Action	Channel	
1	First call	Phone	
3	Send intro email + one-pager	Email	
5	Connect on LinkedIn	LinkedIn	
8	Second call	Phone	
12	Send case study	Email	
15	Final call + voicemail	Phone	

That whole sequence is **one cadence**. The rep works through it step by step until the prospect responds (or until the cadence ends and the deal is flagged as "not responding").

Why It Matters in the System

Automation — When a deal enters a stage, the System auto-creates tasks for each cadence step with due dates. The rep doesn't have to think about "when do I follow up next?"

Consistency — Every rep follows the same rhythm. No deals fall through the cracks.

Measurability — You can measure which cadence works best (e.g., "3 touches over 5 days" vs. "12 touches over 3 weeks").

Template-driven — Different industries need different cadences:

Trades / local service: 3 touches over 5 days (fast, simple)

Marketing agency: 12–15 touches over 3 weeks (slower, more nurturing)

Enterprise SaaS: 20+ touches over 6 weeks (complex, multi-stakeholder)